

ZIRUI ZHAO – CURRICULUM VITAE

CONTACT	School of Computing National University of Singapore 13 Computing Drive Singapore 117417	Email: zirui@comp.nus.edu.sg Website: https://1989ryan.github.io GitHub: 1989Ryan
EDUCATION	Doctor of Philosophy (Ph.D.) in Computer Science National University of Singapore, Singapore Advisor: Prof. Wee Sun Lee & Prof. David Hsu	Aug 2020 - Present
	Bachelor of Engineering (B.Eng.) in Automation Xi'an Jiaotong University, Xi'an, China	Aug 2016 - Jun 2020 GPA: 90.42/100
EXPERIENCE	Teaching Assistant at Department of Computer Science National University of Singapore, Singapore	Aug 2024 - Present
	PhD Research Intern at Salesforce AI Research Salesforce, Singapore	May 2024 - Aug 2024 Mentor: Hanze Dong, Amrita Saha, & Doyen Sahoo
	Undergraduate Research Intern at Safe AI Lab Carnegie Mellon University, Pittsburgh, USA	Jul 2019 - Sep 2019 Advisor: Prof. Ding Zhao
AWARDS	• Student Tutor Honour List School of Computing, NUS, Dec 2024 • Research Achievement Award School of Computing, NUS, Jan 2024 • Teaching Fellowship Nomination School of Computing, NUS, Jan 2024 • Best Paper Runner-up LTAMP workshop @ Robotics: Science & Systems, 2023 • NUS Research Scholarship National University of Singapore, 2020 - 2024 • Excellent Graduate Xi'an Jiaotong University, 2020 • Dean's List Xi'an Jiaotong University, 2017 & 2018 & 2019 • 2nd price – 1989 Mechanical Alumni Scholarship Xi'an Jiaotong University, 2018 • Siyuan Merit Scholarship Xi'an Jiaotong University, 2017	
PUBLICATIONS & MANUSCRIPTS	(*Equal contribution, listed in alphabetical order)	
	[1] Z. Zhao, H. Dong, A. Saha, C. Xiong, and D. Sahoo. "Automatic Curriculum Expert Iteration for Reliable LLM Reasoning". In: <i>The Thirteenth International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)</i>. 2025. URL: https://openreview.net/forum?id=3ogIALgghF. [2] L. Kang*, Z. Zhao*, D. Hsu, and W. S. Lee. "On the Empirical Complexity of Reasoning and Planning in LLMs". In: <i>Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: EMNLP 2024</i>. 2024, pp. 2897–2936. URL: https://aclanthology.org/2024.findings-emnlp.164. [3] Z. Zhao, W. S. Lee, and D. Hsu. "Large Language Models as Commonsense Knowledge for Large-Scale Task Planning". In: <i>Thirty-seventh Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)</i>. 2023. URL: https://openreview.net/forum?id=Wjp1AYB81H. [4] Z. Zhao, W. S. Lee, and D. Hsu. "Differentiable Parsing and Visual Grounding of Natural Language Instructions for Object Placement". In: <i>2023 IEEE International Conference on Robotics and Automation (ICRA)</i>. 2023, pp. 11546–11553. DOI: 10.1109/ICRA48891.2023.10160640. [5] R. Chen, W. Wang, Z. Zhao, and D. Zhao. "Active learning for risk-sensitive inverse reinforcement learning". In: <i>arXiv preprint arXiv:1909.07843</i> (2019).	

- [6] **Z. Zhao**, Y. Mao, Y. Ding, P. Ren, and N. Zheng. “Visual-based semantic SLAM with landmarks for large-scale outdoor environment”. In: *2019 2nd China Symposium on Cognitive Computing and Hybrid Intelligence (CCHI)*. IEEE. 2019, pp. 149–154.

TEACHING

CS1010S Programming Methodology (NUS)

Fall 2024, Spring 2025

Instructor: Dr. Nitya Lakshmanan, Dr. Daren Ler, and Dr. Ashish Deepak Dandekar

- Teach Recitations for Python programming. This is an undergraduate foundation course for the Faculty of Science. It covers the basic Python programming languages and core ideas in programming methodology.

CS3263 Foundations of AI (NUS)

Spring 2023, Fall 2023

Instructor: Prof. Tze-Yun Leong

- Tutor for course tutorials that cover Logic, Search, CSP, Bayesian Networks, Causal Networks, Markov Decision Process, and Reinforcement Learning.